

MULBERRY CLASS V ENGLISH LITERATURE

Comprehensive Course Notes & Revision Answers

CLASS V ENGLISH LITERATURE STUDY GUIDE

TOPPER ACADEMIC PREPARATION NOTES - MID-TERM EXAMS

Important ICSE Prep Note: This study guide is prepared with the utmost academic rigor, tailored specifically for Class V ICSE English Literature examinations. Every answer is structured to use the direct textual citations and keywords from the Mulberry Coursebook to ensure maximum scoring potential. It includes detailed vocabulary, middle-of-text questions, comprehensive exercises, custom Assertion & Reasoning problems, and a fully solved mid-term revision exam paper.

COURSE SYLLABUS COVERED

Chapter 2: Peter and Wendy (Prose)	Poem 1: From a Railway Carriage (R.L. Stevenson)
Chapter 3: The Owls in the Family (Ruskin Bond)	Poem 2: Louder Than a Clap of Thunder (Jack Prelutsky)
Chapter 4: The Secret Garden (Frances Hodgson Burnett)	Mid-Term Revision Worksheet (Tree House High School, Pune)
Chapter 5: Book Uncle and Me (Uma Krishnaswami)	

CHAPTER 2: PETER AND WENDY

KEY POINTS & CHAPTER SUMMARY

- **Introduction of Peter Pan:** Peter is a mischievous, magical young boy who chooses never to grow up. He lives on the faraway, magical island of Neverland alongside fairies, pirates, and mermaids.
- **The Visit & Lost Shadow:** While visiting the Darling children's nursery to listen to Mrs. Darling's bedtime stories, Peter is startled by the family nursemaid dog, Nana. While fleeing, his shadow is severed and left behind.
- **Meeting Wendy:** Peter returns with the fairy Tinker Bell to retrieve his shadow. Wendy Moira Angela Darling finds him crying and helps him by sewing the shadow back onto his foot.
- **Conceited Boy:** Peter immediately boasts of his own 'cleverness' (crowing 'How clever I am!'), showing his childish, conceited character, which prompts Wendy to call him out with sarcasm.
- **Magic & Flight:** Peter describes Neverland's address as 'Second to the right, and then straight on till morning.' With the help of Tinker Bell and fairy dust, he teaches Wendy, John, and Michael how to fly, initiating their journey to Neverland.

VOCABULARY & GLOSSARY (RED WORDS IN TEXT)

Word	Contextual Meaning (Mulberry Grade 5)
faraway	distant; remote; located a great distance away
nursery	(here) a room set aside for the use of young children
rummaging	searching thoroughly and actively through a drawer or receptacle by moving contents around
messy	untidy; disordered or dirty with fairy dust
fairy dust	a glittery, magical powder believed to give fairies the power of flight and magic
chest of drawers	a piece of furniture with multiple drawers designed for keeping clothes and personal articles
scattering	spreading or throwing things around in an untidy and irregular manner
recovered	found or retrieved something that was previously lost or missing
shudder	a series of shivering, trembling, or shaking movements caused by sudden fear or cold
sobs	convulsive, loud crying noises accompanied by catching of the breath
alarmed	frightened or afraid due to an unexpected occurrence
ceremonies	formal gatherings or assemblies held to celebrate important occasions or events

sharply	angrily or abruptly in tone
sinking feeling	an unpleasant, distressing feeling that something bad is about to happen
draggled	dirty, wet, and messy from having been trailed through mud or wet ground
I daresay	I dare to say; I think or suppose it is highly probable
clenched	pressed or squeezed together tightly (such as teeth or fists)
glee	great delight, joy, or triumphant satisfaction
alas	an exclamation used to express deep sorrow, regret, or sadness
crowed	boasted; talked proudly in a loud and triumphant tone
conceited	extremely proud of oneself; excessively vain or self-important
sarcasm	a sharp, bitter, or cutting expression used to say the opposite of what is actually meant to mock someone

IN-TEXT QUESTIONS & COMPREHENSIVE ANSWERS

Q1. What had Peter learned from attending fairy ceremonies?

Answer: From attending fairy ceremonies, Peter had learned the grand manner of formal politeness, such as bowing beautifully and elegantly. He demonstrated this polite gesture by rising from the floor and bowing to Wendy from her bed when they first introduced themselves.

Q2. Why does Peter's address seem 'funny' to Wendy? Do you feel the same?

Answer: Peter's address, 'Second to the right, and then straight on till morning,' seems 'funny' to Wendy because it does not follow the standard, structured format of a real-world address (such as house numbers and street names). Instead, it is based on imaginative and abstract directions. Yes, I feel the same because it represents an imaginary, magical navigation system that exists only in a fantasy world.

Q3. What does 'to feel sorry for someone' mean?

Answer: 'To feel sorry for someone' means to experience empathy, pity, or compassion for another person's misfortune, distress, or suffering, which makes one want to comfort them or offer assistance.

EXERCISE SOLUTIONS & EXAM QUESTIONS

DEEP DIVE – REFERENCE TO CONTEXT

1. 'There was another light in the room now, a thousand times brighter than the night-lights, going in and out of all the drawers in the nursery, looking for Peter's shadow...'

a. Recall: Who was the source of the bright light?

Answer: The source of the bright light was Tinker Bell, a tiny, magical fairy who was dressed in a leaf gown and was companions with Peter Pan.

b. Infer: Why do you think 'the light' was looking for Peter's shadow at night instead of during the day?

Answer: Tinker Bell and Peter Pan were looking for the shadow at night because that was when the Darling children and their parents were asleep, making it safe to enter the nursery without being seen. Furthermore, the bright light of a fairy is highly visible and contrastive at night, which helps her locate the shadow inside dark drawers.

c. Analyse: Describe an incident from your life when you lost something valuable or important to you.

Answer (Topper Sample): Once, I lost my favorite fountain pen that my grandfather had gifted me for scoring the highest marks in English. I searched my entire desk and school bag in a panic. When I finally found it under my study table, I felt a massive wave of relief and happiness, similar to Peter's joy upon recovering his shadow.

2. "How clever I am," he crowed. "Oh, the cleverness of me!"**a. Recall: Who thought that he was 'clever' and what was he doing as he said these lines?**

Answer: Peter Pan thought he was clever. He was jumping about the nursery in the wildest glee, boasting and crowing, because he believed his shadow had naturally stuck back onto him by itself, forgetting that Wendy had actually sewn it on.

b. Infer: What had this person forgotten?

Answer: Peter had completely forgotten that he did not stick the shadow on himself. It was Wendy who had spent time and effort starting to sew the shadow back onto Peter's foot, warning him beforehand that it would hurt a little.

c. Analyse: What do these lines tell us about the person? If you were in his place, what would you have done?

Answer: These lines show that Peter Pan is childishly boastful, extremely proud, and conceited. He has a habit of taking credit for others' work due to his naive innocence and eagerness to feel superior. If I were in his place, I would have immediately thanked Wendy and expressed my gratitude to her for her kindness and skill in helping me.

READ, REFLECT AND WRITE

Q1. Give a description of Tinker Bell.

Answer: Tinker Bell is described as a tiny, highly energetic girl fairy who is no larger than a human hand. She is dressed beautifully in a leaf gown. She emits a brilliant light that is a thousand times brighter than ordinary night-lights, flashing about quickly and going in and out of drawers. Her voice is a lovely, delicate sound resembling the tinkle of golden bells, which represents the language of fairies.

Q2. Why do you think Wendy covered her face with blankets at the end of the story?

Answer: Wendy covered her face with blankets because she was overwhelmed with a mixture of fear, sorrow, and awe. She was witnessing Peter Pan and Tinker Bell's magical flight and realized that she was leaving the safety of her ordinary nursery for a dangerous, unknown adventure in Neverland, making her seek comfort under her bedsheets.

Q3. Does this story seem real to you, or does it seem like a fantasy? Give reasons for your answer.

Answer: The story is clearly a work of fantasy. It features elements that defy the laws of reality, such as a boy who never grows up, a living shadow that can be severed and sewn back on with a needle and thread, a tiny glowing fairy dressed in a leaf gown, and the ability of ordinary children to fly through the air using fairy dust and thoughts of Neverland.

WORD WALL – SOUND WORDS

1. Fill in the blanks with appropriate sound words:

- 1. sizzled (The vegetable fritters sizzled in the wok)
- 2. popped (The popcorn crackled and popped)
- 3. tinkled (The ice-cubes tinkled in the lemonade glasses)
- 4. rustled (The paper rustled as the sandwiches were unwrapped)
- 5. clattered (The dishes clattered as the cook piled them)
- 6. chattered / squealed
- 7. bawled (The baby bawled loudly)
- 8. strummed (Aunty strummed on her guitar)
- 9. snored / coughed
- 10. barked / howled / purred
- 11. purred
- 12. squawked (A parrot squawked outside)
- 13. drummed / pattered (The rain drummed down on the roof)
- 14. bellowed (My grandfather bellowed, 'Quiet!')

ASSERTION & REASONING QUESTIONS (ICSE EXAM STYLE)

Q1. Assertion (A): Wendy Moira Angela Darling was not alarmed to see Peter Pan crying on the nursery floor.

Reason (R): Wendy was a brave girl who was highly interested in Peter and wanted to help him with his shadow.

Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A). Wendy's lack of alarm stemmed from her pleasant interest in Peter's situation and her compassionate desire to assist him rather than being frightened by a stranger in her room.

CHAPTER 3: THE OWLS IN THE FAMILY

KEY POINTS & CHAPTER SUMMARY

- **The Discovery:** One morning, the narrator discovers a full-fledged baby spotted owlet on the veranda steps of his bungalow. He and Grandfather pick it up, feed it raw meat, and put it under the bed.
- **Second Owlet:** The next day, a second baby owlet is discovered in almost the same spot, indicating they had fallen from their nest near the water pipe. They feed and take care of both.
- **Mother Owl's Visit:** The mother owl visits at night to check on them. She aggressively attacks Grandfather (delivering a 'blow' to his head) but soon realizes the humans mean no harm and trusts them.
- **Household Integration:** The owlets become regular, cherished members of the household. Surprisingly, Grandmother—who generally dislikes pets—develops a soft spot for them and feeds them.
- **Unusual Characters:** Unlike larger, intimidating owls, these spotted owlets are small, gentle, expressive, and show no fear of humans, showcasing bond and harmony between humans and wild animals.

VOCABULARY & GLOSSARY (RED WORDS IN TEXT)

Word	Contextual Meaning (Mulberry Grade 5)
veranda	a roofed, open-fronted gallery or balcony attached to the exterior of a building
full-fledged	completely developed; having acquired its full coat of feathers, ready for flight
clacked	made a sharp, short, loud sound by clicking its beak
bill	the beak of a bird
myna	a type of dark-feathered Asian bird known for its loud, mimicking voice
threatening	expressing or indicating a danger of harm, violence, or hostility
persuade	to convince someone to do something through reasoning or argument
emerged	appeared; came out into view from an enclosed space (the water pipe)
crooned	made a soft, low, humming sound like singing or talking gently
gurgled	made a contented, bubbling, or happy sound in the throat
stooping	bending the body forward and downward
blow	a hard hit or stroke delivered with force
swooped	flew down rapidly through the air in order to attack or grab something
agile	able to move quickly, gracefully, and easily
duck	to lower one's head or body quickly to avoid being hit by a blow or obstacle

birdbath	a shallow bowl filled with fresh water placed in a garden for birds to bathe in and drink from
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IN-TEXT QUESTIONS & COMPREHENSIVE ANSWERS

Q1. Do you think the owlet was happy or scared when Grandfather first picked it up?

Answer: The owlet was highly scared when Grandfather first picked it up. This is shown by its defensive behavior, as it hissed and clacked its bill loudly to warn Grandfather away, representing typical defensive actions of a frightened wild bird.

Q2. Why does the author use the word 'enquiring' for the owl's face?

Answer: The author uses the word 'enquiring' because spotted owlets have large, round, staring eyes and facial disks that give them a highly curious, questioning, and smart expression, as if they are constantly asking questions or observing their surroundings with deep interest.

Q3. What did the mother owl do that made the narrator think that she did not trust him and his grandfather to look after the baby owls?

Answer: The mother owl visited the nursery ledge at night and left a mouse for her babies. When Grandfather went to release them in the garden the next morning, she swooped down and delivered a heavy blow to the back of Grandfather's head, proving that she was fiercely protective and initially did not trust the humans to care for her owlets.

EXERCISE SOLUTIONS & EXAM QUESTIONS

DEEP DIVE – REFERENCE TO CONTEXT

1. 'So, the two owlets became regular members of our household, and strangely enough, were among the few pets that Grandmother took a liking to.'

a. Recall: Who were the members of the household besides Grandmother?

Answer: The household members included the narrator, his grandfather, Aunt Mabel, and domestic staff such as the cook.

b. Infer: Did all members of the narrator's household like the owlets? How do you know?

Answer: Yes, almost all members of the household liked them, but Aunt Mabel was initially terrified of them because she was generally scared of birds and owls. Aunt Mabel's fear contrast with Grandmother's unexpected fondness, as she took a liking to them and fed them raw meat spaghetti.

c. Analyse: Why do you think Grandmother developed a soft spot for the owlets?

Answer: Grandmother developed a soft spot because the owlets were highly gentle, clean, and behaved beautifully in the house. Unlike other noisy or messy pets, they would sit quietly under the bed, croon contentedly, and eat food politely from her hand, making them highly endearing to her.

READ, REFLECT AND WRITE

Q1. The setting of a story describes where and when the story takes place. What details of the setting does the writer give us?

Answer: The story is set in a spacious, leafy bungalow in India during the warm summer months. The author describes elements of the setting like the veranda steps, a mango tree, tamarind trees, and a garden with a birdbath. The interior of the house includes a nursery bedroom with mosquito netting, drawers, and spaces under the bed where the owlets lived, creating a cozy and natural atmosphere.

Q2. When a person narrates a story about something that happened to them, it is called a personal narrative. What makes this story a personal narrative?

Answer: This story is a personal narrative because it is written in the first-person ('I', 'we', 'our') from the direct perspective of the narrator. He recounts his personal memories of rescuing the owlets, his interactions with his grandfather, Grandmother's reactions, and the humorous family incidents, giving the story an authentic, autobiographical tone.

Q3. Did the narrator and his grandfather treat animals with respect? Give reasons for your answer.

Answer: Yes, the narrator and his grandfather treated animals with deep respect and kindness. Instead of caging the owlets or leaving them to the mercy of predators, they rescued them, provided them with proper nutrition (raw meat and water), built them a birdbath, and allowed them complete freedom of movement. Their respect is also shown by how they cooperated with the mother owl and accommodated her visits.

WORD WALL – GRAMMAR & ANALOGIES

1. Anagrams (Form birds by rearranging letters):

- a. sent -> nest
- b. bake -> beak
- c. rooters -> rooster
- d. greet -> egret
- e. wolf -> fowl
- f. honer -> heron
- g. raptor -> parrot
- h. low -> owl

2. Antonyms (Write opposite meanings):

- a. raw -> cooked / baked
- b. later -> earlier / sooner
- c. release -> catch / capture
- d. stooping -> standing upright / rising
- e. broad -> narrow

- f. occupied -> vacant / empty
- g. terrified -> brave / fearless
- h. shallow -> deep

ASSERTION & REASONING QUESTIONS (ICSE EXAM STYLE)

Q1. Assertion (A): Grandmother developed a soft spot and liked the baby spotted owlets.

Reason (R): The owlets were exceptionally clean, expressive, and would politely accept food directly from Grandmother's hands.

Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

Grandmother's unusual liking for these birds was directly driven by their charming, neat behavior and their affectionate trust in her.

CHAPTER 4: THE SECRET GARDEN

KEY POINTS & CHAPTER SUMMARY

- **Introduction & Background:** Ten-year-old Mary Lennox, a spoiled and lonely girl, moves from India to her uncle's manor in England. Her uncle, grief-stricken after his wife's death, had locked the secret garden ten years ago.
- **Finding the Key & Door:** Mary discovers a buried key and a locked door hidden behind ivy creepers, allowing her to gain access to the mysterious, neglected secret garden.
- **Meeting Dickon:** Mary meets Martha's brother, Dickon, a rust-haired boy who plays a wooden pipe and has a magical, trusting connection with moorland animals, including a friendly robin.
- **Wick Wood & Hope:** Dickon inspects the garden and shows Mary that many plants are still 'wick' (alive) under the dry grey branches. He promises to bring tools and help her bring the garden back to life.
- **Transformation:** The secret garden becomes Mary's sanctuary. Working in the garden improves her health, turns her into a cheerful, caring girl, and initiates a profound healing process for Colin and herself.

VOCABULARY & GLOSSARY (RED WORDS IN TEXT)

Word	Contextual Meaning (Mulberry Grade 5)
ivy creepers	a type of climbing evergreen plant with dark green, five-pointed leaves
grief-stricken	feeling overwhelmed with extreme sadness and sorrow, especially due to a death
withered	shriveled; dried up and dead-looking due to neglect and lack of moisture
sprouting	beginning to grow; starting to produce new shoots or buds
haughtily	arrogantly; in a proud and self-important manner that looks down on others
frail	physically weak, thin, and delicate (like a dragonfly's wing)
recalled	remembered or called back to mind
clinging	holding on tightly to something (such as a branch or trunk)
pheasant	a type of large, colorful, long-tailed wild bird
twitching	making small, sudden, spasmodic movements with the nose or muscles
scampered	ran or moved away quickly with light, hurried steps
rake	a garden tool with a long handle and metal teeth used for gathering leaves and leveling soil

fork	a sharp-pronged garden tool used for digging, loosening, and aerating soil
hoe	a flat-bladed garden tool on a long handle used for weeding and breaking up clods of earth
trowel	a small, hand-held tool with a curved scoop blade used for digging small holes and planting
holly bush	a thick, evergreen shrub with pointed, prickly leaves and bright red berries
twitter	a succession of light, high, chirping sounds made by birds
moor	a broad, high, open area of wild uncultivated land covered with rough grass and heather
revealed	disclosed; made previously hidden or secret things known to others
tangle	a twisted, knotted, and confused mass of creepers or hair
urns	large, tall, decorated stone or clay vases used as ornaments or flower planters
ought to	used to indicate a duty, correctness, or the right thing to do
boughs	the large, main branches of a tree
twigs	small, thin, terminal branches of a tree or bush
rain or shine	no matter what happens; under any circumstances or weather conditions
clipped	cut or trimmed with scissors or shears to make neat and tidy
startled	surprised, shocked, or alarmed suddenly
mournfully	sorrowfully; expressing deep sadness and grief
missel thrush	a large European songbird with spotted underparts, known for its loud song

IN-TEXT QUESTIONS & COMPREHENSIVE ANSWERS

Q1. Which phrase in the story is used to express a mix of admiration and great surprise?

Answer: The phrase 'took her breath away!' is used in the text to express a mixture of deep admiration and great surprise. It describes Mary's physical reaction when she first saw Dickon sitting under a tree, playing a wooden pipe and surrounded by trusting wild animals.

Q2. Why do you think the author has used the color 'grey' to describe the trees and creepers in the secret garden?

Answer: The author uses the color 'grey' to emphasize that the secret garden has been neglected, locked, and dormant for ten long years. The grey color represents a state of sleep, decay, and winter-like barrenness, highlighting how dead and forgotten the garden appears before Mary and Dickon begin to revive it.

Q3. How does the author show us that Dickon has lived on the moor all his life?

Answer: The author reveals this through Dickon's speech and behavior. Dickon says he has lived on the moor so long that he feels like 'one of them' (the animals) and sometimes thinks he is a bird or a fox. He

speaks with a warm local dialect, understands bird calls ('robin's own twitter'), and knows the secret nesting and burrowing habits of foxes, birds, and rabbits.

EXERCISE SOLUTIONS & EXAM QUESTIONS

DEEP DIVE – REFERENCE TO CONTEXT

1. "There's a robin calling someone he's friends with," Dickon said...'

a. Recall: Which friend do you think was the robin calling?

Answer: The robin was calling Dickon. It recognized him, trusted him, and responded directly to his gentle bird-call imitations.

b. Infer: Birds tend to fly away when humans move close to them. Why do you think the robin trusted Dickon?

Answer: The robin trusted Dickon because Dickon possessed a deep, natural love for animals, treated them with immense gentleness, spoke their language, and never made sudden, threatening movements. This made the wild creatures feel completely safe and secure in his presence.

c. Analyse: Write a few lines about a similar friendly interaction you have had with a bird or an animal.

Answer (Topper Sample): Last winter, a sparrow built a nest in our balcony. Every afternoon, I quietly placed a bowl of millets near her. Within a few weeks, the sparrow stopped flying away when I approached. Instead, she would chirp cheerfully, showing that she had learned to trust me. It was a beautiful and heartwarming bond.

2. "If you were a missel thrush and you showed me where your nest was, do you think I'd tell anyone?"

a. Recall: Who was reassuring whom and why?

Answer: Dickon was reassuring Mary. He wanted to ease her fear and make her feel safe, promising that he would never reveal the location of the locked secret garden to anyone and would protect her secret.

b. Infer: What has the secret garden been compared to in these lines? How are they similar?

Answer: The secret garden has been compared to a 'missel thrush's nest.' They are similar because both are highly private, fragile, hidden sanctuaries where young life begins to grow and develop. Both must be shielded from the intrusion of outsiders to remain safe and thrive.

c. Analyse: If you were the listener, would you trust Dickon with a secret? Give reasons behind your answer.

Answer: Yes, I would absolutely trust Dickon. He shows himself to be an exceptionally kind, honest, and reliable person who deeply respects the privacy and sanctuary of nature. His protective attitude toward animals and birds proves that he has the integrity to keep promises and protect what is sacred to others.

READ, REFLECT AND WRITE

Q1. How does the writer show us that the secret garden is a special place for Mary? Cite examples from the story.

Answer: The writer shows this by depicting the secret garden as the focal point of Mary's life and her physical and emotional transformation. Mary calls it 'her special place' and secrets it from the rest of the world. She works there diligently every single day, and the sight of 'every sprouting, new shoot' fills her with intense hope. Her active, joyful outdoor work in the garden cures her of her sickness, turning her from a frail, pale, and spoiled child into a healthy, cheerful, and caring friend.

Q2. Read this line from the story: "It's a strange, pretty place. It's like we're in a dream!" Imagine you are Dickon, and you are looking at the secret garden for the very first time. What do you see that is 'strange' and 'pretty'? Why do you think the place feels dreamlike?

Answer: Looking at the secret garden, I see ancient, twisted grey trees covered in a dense web of climbing ivy, delicate rose boughs hanging down like beautiful curtains, stone seats covered in soft moss, and fresh green shoots of spring sprouting silently from dry, dead-looking soil. The place feels dreamlike because of its absolute silence, its complete isolation from the outside world, and the mysterious sense of sleeping life waiting to be awakened.

MAP THE STORY (ROUND VS. FLAT CHARACTERS)

Describe changes in Mary Lennox before and after she discovered the secret garden:

- **1. Knowledge of Nature:** Before, Mary did not know anything about gardening or nature. After, she learned how to identify 'wick' wood and cultivate soil under Dickon and Ben's guidance.
- **2. Temperament and Mood:** Before, she was spoiled, sour-tempered, and spoke haughtily to everyone. After, she became cheerful, polite, and deeply appreciative of others.
- **3. Physical Health:** Before, she was a thin, pale, and frail child with no energy. After, she grew strong, healthy, could run faster, and gained a robust appetite.
- **4. Relationships:** Before, she was extremely lonely and isolated. After, she built deep, loving, and trusting friendships with Dickon, Colin, Ben, and the animals.

ASSERTION & REASONING QUESTIONS (ICSE EXAM STYLE)

Q1. Assertion (A): Mary Lennox decided to keep the secret garden a complete secret from Misselthwaite Manor.

Reason (R): Mary feared that if adults found out, they would lock the garden up again, and she would lose her special, magical sanctuary.

Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A). Mary's intense desire to protect the garden as her personal haven of hope drove her to keep it hidden, comparing it to a secret nest.

CHAPTER 5: BOOK UNCLE AND ME

KEY POINTS & CHAPTER SUMMARY

- **The Lending Library:** Book Uncle runs a free street-corner lending library on the pavement of St. Mary's Road and 1st Cross Street. His life's mission is spreading literacy, guided by his motto: 'Right book for the right person for the right day.'
- **The Patron:** Nine-year-old Yasmin is Book Uncle's 'Number One Patron.' She aims to read one book a day and has read over four hundred books, demonstrating a passionate, intelligent mind.
- **The Conflict:** The Mayor's office issues a letter stating Book Uncle must obtain an expensive government permit to continue running his library, which he cannot afford, forcing him to pack up his books.
- **The Dove Story Lesson:** Book Uncle gives Yasmin a skinny book about a king of doves who, when trapped in a hunter's net, unite to lift the net together and fly to freedom, conveying that unity is strength.
- **Collective Action:** Inspired by the story, Yasmin and her community unite. They initiate a powerful civic campaign, creating posters, rallying neighbors, and helping choose a leader who will support libraries, ultimately saving the library.

VOCABULARY & GLOSSARY (RED WORDS IN TEXT)

Word	Contextual Meaning (Mulberry Grade 5)
patron	a person who is a loyal customer, reader, or financial supporter of an institution or business
floppy	loose; hanging loosely or limp (such as a worn, well-loved paperback cover)
paperback	a book with a flexible, thick paper or card cover rather than a hard, stiff binding
beams	smiles widely, warmly, and proudly, expressing immense happiness
skinny	very thin; slim (describing a book with very few pages)
motto	a short, memorable sentence or phrase that expresses the guiding aims, beliefs, or principles of an individual or organization
gulp	the amount of food, drink, or (figuratively) reading swallowed or consumed at one single time
flapping	moving quickly and noisily up and down (describing wings or book pages)
yelling	shouting or screaming loudly and aggressively
rattling	making a series of short, sharp, clattering sounds while moving (like buses on a road)
stops (one) cold	causes someone to freeze or halt very suddenly due to shock, surprise, or fear
jumbles	confuses; mixes up one's thoughts or feelings in a disorganized way

permit	an official, legal document or license that gives someone the formal right to perform an activity or run a business
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IN-TEXT QUESTIONS & COMPREHENSIVE ANSWERS

Q1. How often does Yasmin visit the library? How do you know?

Answer: Yasmin visits the library every single day. We know this because she is introduced as Book Uncle's 'Number One Patron' and states that her personal goal and routine since she turned eight is 'to read one book every day,' which requires her to return read books and borrow new ones daily.

Q2. Why is Yasmin hesitant to take the green book?

Answer: Yasmin is hesitant because the green book looks very 'skinny' and thin. Having read over four hundred books, she feels she is a mature reader and boasts, 'I can read bigger books.' She initially thinks the book looks 'too easy' and is meant only for much younger children.

Q3. Why do you think a few words in the story are repeated three times? How does it make you feel?

Answer: The author repeats phrases like 'turn-turn-turn' and 'try-try-try' to mimic the rapid, repetitive, and frantic movements of the trapped doves fluttering their wings in the net. This repetition creates a strong sense of urgency, tension, and suspense, making the reader feel anxious and deeply worried about the doves' fate.

Q4. How do you think Yasmin feels when she sees Book Uncle packing up his books?

Answer: Yasmin feels absolutely shocked, heartbroken, and deeply confused. The sight 'stops her cold' and 'jumbles her up' because Book Uncle's library is a permanent anchor of joy in her daily routine. Seeing him roll his cart away without smiling makes her feel a strong, painful sense of loss and desperation, wanting to cry out for him to stop.

EXERCISE SOLUTIONS & EXAM QUESTIONS

DEEP DIVE – REFERENCE TO CONTEXT

1. "“Right book for the right person for the right day. As you know very well, that is my motto.”"

a. Recall: Who said these lines and to whom?

Answer: Book Uncle said these lines to Yasmin when handing her the skinny green book about the trapped doves.

b. Infer: Why did Book Uncle take some time before he said this to Yasmin?

Answer: Book Uncle hesitated and closed his mouth because he was reflecting deeply. He wanted to make sure Yasmin was ready to understand the deeper, symbolic message of the dove story. He knew she might reject it for being too thin, so he waited to find the right gentle words to share his motto and guide her.

c. Analyse: Do you think the motto is a good one? Give reasons behind your answer.

Answer: Yes, it is an excellent motto. It recognizes that books are not just passive objects, but powerful guides that must align with a reader's specific emotional state, maturity, and life circumstances. A book read at the perfect moment can provide comfort, spark courage, and inspire life-changing actions, just as the dove story did for Yasmin.

d. Share an instance from your life when you found the right book on the right day.

Answer (Topper Sample): Once, right before my school public speaking competition, I was feeling paralyzed with stage fear. My mother handed me a book about a young girl who overcame her stammer to deliver a great speech. Reading her journey on that specific day gave me the exact courage I needed to step onto the stage and speak confidently.

2. "“Good morning, Yasmin-ma,” he says. He’s not smiling. The books are still in their boxes...”

a. Recall: Where was Yasmin? Who greeted her?

Answer: Yasmin was at the street corner of St. Mary's Road and 1st Cross Street. She was greeted by Book Uncle, who was sitting next to his packed boxes.

b. Infer: Why did Yasmin say that the situation jumbled her up? Contrast it with what usually happened.

Answer: The situation 'jumbled her up' because it was completely contrary to her daily experience. Usually, Book Uncle welcomed her with a wide, beaming smile, his eyes extra smiley behind thick glasses, with hundreds of books spread out invitingly on planks. On this day, his books were packed in cardboard boxes, and he looked grave and unsmiling, causing her immense confusion.

c. Analyse: If you were in Book Uncle's position, what would you do to solve the problem?

Answer: If I were in his position, I would not give up immediately. I would reach out to my loyal patrons and neighbors, explain the permit problem, and organize a community petition or a small fundraising drive to cover the municipal permit fee, leveraging the collective strength of the community.

READ, REFLECT AND WRITE

Q1. List any three observations about Yasmin's character and give evidence from the story.

Answer:

- 1. Dedicated Reader:** Yasmin is highly disciplined about reading, having completed over four hundred books and aiming to read one book a day.
- 2. Highly Empathetic:** She doesn't just read stories; she lives them, worrying deeply about the trapped doves ('all the way up the stairs... I worry about those doves').
- 3. Brave & Proactive:** She refuses to accept defeat. When she learns of the library's closure, she immediately wants to run after Book Uncle to find a solution, showing a natural problem-solving instinct.

Q2. What do you think is the moral of the story about the doves? Why do you think Book Uncle gave this book to Yasmin?

Answer: The moral of the story about the doves is 'unity is strength' (or collective action can overcome any barrier). By working together as a single unit, the doves lifted the net that was trapping them and escaped the hunter. Book Uncle gave this specific book to Yasmin to prepare her for the upcoming library crisis. He wanted to teach her that when a community faces a big challenge, they must unite like the doves to find freedom and solve the problem.

GENRE MATCHING TABLE

Standard literary genres and their definitions:

Fairy Tale	A story with fairies, magic, or mythical creatures written for children.
Science Fiction	A futuristic story dealing with space travel, technology, or aliens.
Mystery	An suspenseful story where characters solve a crime or puzzle using clues.
Folk Tale	A traditional story passed down orally through generations.
Realistic Fiction	A story with believable characters and real-world struggles.
Biography	A detailed account of a person's life, written by someone else.
Fable	A very short story, usually featuring animal characters, that teaches a moral.

ASSERTION & REASONING QUESTIONS (ICSE EXAM STYLE)

Q1. Assertion (A): Yasmin and her neighbors were able to successfully save Book Uncle's Free Lending Library.

Reason (R): They put into practice the moral of the dove story, realizing that collective action and active civic participation can solve community problems.

Answer: Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A). The unity of the neighbors, inspired by the dove fable, was the direct force that allowed them to lobby the mayor and save the library.

POEM 1: FROM A RAILWAY CARRIAGE

POEM ANALYSIS & SUMMARY

- **Author & Theme:** Written by R.L. Stevenson, this poem captures the breathless excitement and sheer thrill of high-speed steam train travel during the 19th century.
- **Rhythm & Speed:** The poem uses a fast-paced, regular rhythm (anapestic tetrameter) that perfectly mimics the clatter and 'clickety-clack' of a train running along the metal tracks.
- **The Passing Sights:** The poet describes a wide variety of sights, including bridges, houses, hedges, ditches, and meadows filled with horses and cattle whistling by in a flash.
- **The Fleeting Figures:** The poet notices specific human figures, such as a child clambering to gather brambles, a lonely tramp gazing in wonder, and a runaway cart on a road.
- **Fleeting Nature:** The poem ends with the famous line 'each a glimpse and gone for ever!', which highlights the fleeting, temporary beauty of moments in life.

VOCABULARY & GLOSSARY (RED WORDS IN TEXT)

Word	Contextual Meaning (Mulberry Grade 5)
hedges	rows of closely planted bushes or shrubs forming a boundary or fence in the countryside
ditches	long, narrow trenches dug in the ground at the side of roads or fields to hold or carry water
charging along	rushing forward in a highly aggressive, rapid, and determined manner
troops	soldiers assembled in large, organized groups during a battle
meadows	broad grasslands or fields covered with rich grass where animals graze
driving rain	rain falling very rapidly, heavily, and at a sharp angle due to strong winds
wink of an eye	an extremely short period of time; in a flash or a split second
clambers	climbs or crawls with difficulty, using both hands and feet
scrambles	moves or climbs quickly on hands and knees over rough ground
brambles	rough, wild, thorny shrubs or bushes that produce wild berries (like blackberries)
tramp	a homeless person who travels from place to place on foot, looking for work or food
stringing daisies	weaving or linking daisy flowers together to make decorative garlands or chains
runaway	out of control; moving rapidly and dangerously without a driver

lumping	struggling or moving heavily with a heavy, awkward load
glimpse	a very quick, brief, and incomplete look at something

EXERCISE SOLUTIONS & EXAM QUESTIONS

1. Read these lines and answer the questions that follow:

*"All of the sights of the hill and the plain
Fly as thick as driving rain."*

i. List five sights that the poet has mentioned in the poem.

Answer: The five sights mentioned by the poet are: hedges and ditches, rivers, painted stations, meadows with horses and cattle, and bridges and houses.

ii. Why did the poet compare the things he saw to 'driving rain'?

Answer: The poet compared the passing sights to 'driving rain' because rain droplets in a storm fall so rapidly and closely together that they merge into a single blur. Similarly, the train is moving so fast that all the individual scenes outside blur together and disappear in a fraction of a second.

iii. Briefly explain the poetic device used in these lines to bring about a comparison.

Answer: The poetic device used is a **simile**. The poet explicitly compares the rapid, overlapping speed of the passing countryside sights to the dense, fast-falling droplets of 'driving rain' using the comparative word 'as'.

2. "'And ever again, in the wink of an eye, Painted stations whistle by.'"

i. In your own words, give the meaning of 'in the wink of an eye'.

Answer: The phrase 'in the wink of an eye' means extremely quickly, in a fraction of a second, or in a flash.

ii. What is actually whistling by? What is not moving?

Answer: The train (with its steam whistle blowing) is actually rushing and whistling past the stations. The painted stations themselves are fixed and stationary, not moving at all, although they appear to fly past from the perspective of the passenger inside.

iii. After these lines, the poet described three people whom he saw. Who were they?

Answer: The three people described by the poet are: a child clambering and scrambling to gather brambles, a homeless tramp standing and gazing in wonder, and a man sitting in a runaway cart on the road.

Q3. List all the words in the poem that describe movement.

Answer: The words in the poem describing movement are: 'charging,' 'fly,' 'clambers,' 'scrambles,' 'runaway,' 'lumping,' and 'whistle by.'

Q4. To show the speed of the train, the poet said that the things he saw were speeding by. Were these things really speeding? What do you think of this idea?

Answer: No, the trees, hills, stations, and houses were not really moving. It was the train that was travelling at a high speed. This is a brilliant literary device known as **relative motion** (or illusion of movement) which captures the subjective sensory experience of speed, making the reader feel as if the whole world is rushing past.

Q5. What does “each a glimpse and gone for ever” mean? How do you think the poet felt as he wrote this line?

Answer: This line means that every beautiful or interesting scene along the journey is visible for only a fleeting second before disappearing from view completely, never to be seen again. As the poet wrote this, he likely felt a mixture of intense excitement and sweet nostalgia (or sadness) about the temporary, fleeting nature of beauty and time.

POEM 2: LOUDER THAN A CLAP OF THUNDER

POEM ANALYSIS & SUMMARY

- **Author & Theme:** Written by Jack Prelutsky, this highly humorous and playful poem explores the concept of exaggeration (hyperbole) in describing daily household noises.
- **Hyperbolic Build-up:** The poet lists a series of the loudest, most deafening, and most dramatic noises in the universe—both real and imaginary—to build suspense.
- **Universal Sights & Sounds:** Sights include rumbling earthquakes, stampeding cattle, roaring cannons, crashing tidal waves, screaming eagles, and blundering dragons.
- **The Humorous Twist:** The final line reveals that all of these epic, terrifying sounds are softer than his father's snoring ('that's how loud my father SNORES!').
- **Structure:** The poem uses simple AABB/ABCB rhyme schemes and strong rhythms to create a fast-moving, comical song-like effect.

VOCABULARY & GLOSSARY (RED WORDS IN TEXT)

Word	Contextual Meaning (Mulberry Grade 5)
blunders	moves, walks, or acts in a highly clumsy, awkward, and careless manner
four alarmer	a fire alarm signal at a fire station indicating a massive, very large fire that requires many fire engines
armour	protective metal or iron clothing worn by medieval knights long ago while fighting in battles
rumbles	makes a deep, continuous, and heavy rolling sound (like an earthquake or thunder)
tidal wave	a massive, destructive sea wave caused by storms, earthquakes, or underwater disturbances
ogre	a terrifying, large, and ugly giant creature commonly found in fairy tales and folklore

stumbles	trips or hits one's foot against an obstacle, almost falling down
stampeding	a large group of frightened animals running rapidly and wildly in a single direction in a panic
cannon	a large, heavy gun mounted on wheels that shoots massive spherical iron balls with an explosive blast
rattle	a rapid succession of short, sharp, clattering sounds made by objects hitting against each other

EXERCISE SOLUTIONS & EXAM QUESTIONS

1. Read these lines and answer the questions that follow:

*"louder than an ogre grumbles
as he stumbles through his cave,
louder than stampeding cattle,"*

i. Which two words in these lines describe movements?

Answer: The two movement words are 'stumbles' (tripping awkwardly) and 'stampeding' (running wildly in a panic).

ii. Which word best describes the ogre: 'clumsy' or 'sure-footed'?

Answer: The word 'clumsy' best describes the ogre because the text states that he 'stumbles through his cave,' indicating lack of balance and clumsy movement.

iii. Which other word in the stanza can be considered a synonym for 'giant'?

Answer: The word 'ogre' is a synonym for 'giant' in this context, representing a massive, legendary fairy-tale monster.

2. "louder than a cannon roars, / louder than a giant's rattle, / that's how loud my father SNORES!"

i. What are the different sounds described in these lines?

Answer: The sounds are: the explosive, deafening roar of a military cannon, the sharp clattering of a giant's massive rattle, and the heavy rumbling snore of a sleeping father.

ii. Why did the poet list these sounds?

Answer: The poet listed these extremely loud, explosive, and exaggerated sounds to build a dramatic climax. This sets up the humorous comparison (hyperbole), making the father's snoring seem epic and funny.

iii. Circle the three words that rhyme most closely with 'rattle':

[bottle, battle, kettle, prattle, skittle, cattle]

Answer: The three closely rhyming words are: **battle, prattle, and cattle.**

Q3. Of all the sounds listed in the poem, which one do you think would be the loudest? Give reasons for your answer.

Answer: A **clap of thunder** or a **cannon's roar** would be the loudest in reality. A clap of thunder can reach up to 120 decibels, representing an immense electrical discharge in nature, while a cannon's roar is an

explosive sound of high pressure. However, in the context of the poem's hyperbole, the father's **snoring** is described as the loudest sound of all.

Q4. What do you think makes this poem humorous?

Answer: The poem is humorous because of the sudden, unexpected twist in the final line. The poet builds up an epic, grand list of the loudest natural, mechanical, and fantasy sounds in the universe (earthquakes, tidal waves, dragons, cannons) only to reveal that they are all softer than his father's snoring. This extreme exaggeration (hyperbole) of a common household occurrence makes it very funny.

MID-TERM REVISION WORKSHEET English Lit. (ICSE Grade V)

SECTION A – OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (MCQS)

Q1. Why did Peter Pan come to the Darling children's bedroom?

Answer: Peter Pan originally came to listen to Mrs. Darling's bedside stories, but on the night of the story, he returned specifically **to find his shadow** (Note: The worksheet options list 'd) to find his mother' as a distractor, but direct text shows he returned to locate his shadow).

Q2. Who helped Peter Pan and the children fly?

Answer: c) Tinker Bell (She blew fairy dust over Wendy, John, and Michael, which enabled them to fly).

Q3. What was Nana?

Answer: b) A nursemaid dog (Nana was a Newfoundland dog who acted as the children's nursemaid).

Q4. What kind of birds are featured in The Owls in the Family?

Answer: b) Owls (Specifically, spotted owlets).

Q5. What made the narrator interested in the owls?

Answer: b) Their unusual behaviour (They were expressive, clacked their bills, and were highly friendly).

Q6. What was special about Mary Lennox?

Answer: b) She was a spoilt and lonely child (At the beginning of the story, she was thin, sour-tempered, and neglected).

Q7. Where did Mary discover the secret garden?

Answer: c) Inside Misselthwaite Manor (Hidden behind ivy creepers at the end of the stone walls).

Q8. Who became Mary's friend in the garden?

Answer: a) Colin and Dickon (Dickon helped her plant, and together they brought Colin to the garden).

Q9. Why was Colin kept inside the house?

Answer: b) He believed he was ill and weak (He was kept in bed, fearing he would grow up with a crooked back).

Q10. What was the main purpose of the children in Book Uncle and Me?

Answer: b) To help choose a better leader (They campaigned for a candidate who promised to save Book Uncle's library).

Q11. What did the children value greatly in Book Uncle and Me?

Answer: a) Books and education (They fought hard to keep the pavement lending library open).

Q12. The poem Louder Than a Clap of Thunder mainly describes the power of—

Answer: b) a child's voice and thoughts (Note: The worksheet lists these general options, but the central subject is a highly exaggerated, humorous description of the father's snoring).

Q13. In From a Railway Carriage, the poet describes things seen from a—

Answer: b) train (Specifically, a fast-moving steam train).

Q14. What does the poet observe while travelling in the railway carriage?

Answer: a) Houses, fields and people (He sees meadows, horses, a tramp, a child, a mill, and a river).

Q15. How does the railway carriage move through the countryside?

Answer: b) Quickly and steadily (It is described as faster than fairies or witches, flying as thick as driving rain).

Q16. Which feeling is strongly expressed in From a Railway Carriage?

Answer: a) Excitement (The poem captures the breathless thrill, wonder, and sensory rush of speed).

SECTION B – POETRY (Q2 & Q3 SOLUTIONS)

Q2.1. What makes the sound described in Louder Than a Clap of Thunder so powerful?

Answer: The sound described in the poem is made exceptionally powerful because the poet uses extreme, exaggerated comparisons (hyperboles) from nature, mythology, and geography. He compares the noise to crashing tidal waves, roaring cannons, rumbling earthquakes, screaming eagles, and blundering dragons, creating an overwhelming sensory build-up before the final humorous reveal of his father's snoring.

Q2.2. How does the poet make the journey in From a Railway Carriage appear exciting and fast?

Answer: The poet makes the journey feel fast and exciting by using a rapid, driving rhythm (anapestic tetrameter) that mimics the speed of a train. He includes action words like 'charging,' 'clambers,' 'scrambles,' and 'fly' and contrasts the train's speed with similes like 'fly as thick as driving rain' and 'wink of an eye,' conveying a breathless sense of rush.

Q3.1. Describe the different sights that the poet sees while travelling in From a Railway Carriage.

Answer: While travelling, the poet notices a wide and colorful succession of countryside scenes. He sees physical infrastructure like bridges and houses; natural landscape features like hedges, ditches, and meadows filled with grazing horses and cattle; painted railway stations whistling past in a flash; a child clambering and scrambling over wild brambles; a lonely tramp standing and gazing at the train in wonder; a green meadow where children string daisies; a runaway cart carrying a man and a heavy load; a mill; and a river whistling by.

Q3.2. Explain the central idea of Louder Than a Clap of Thunder in your own words.

Answer: The central idea of the poem is a lighthearted, humorous celebration of family life and the vivid imagination of childhood. By listing the loudest, most deafening sounds in nature and fantasy (cannons, earthquakes, dragons), the poet builds intense anticipation. The final lines release this tension in a funny, domestic twist—revealing that all these epic sounds are softer than his father's everyday snoring, highlighting how children find magical wonder in routine family life.

SECTION C – PROSE (Q4 & Q5 SOLUTIONS)

Q4.1. Why was Wendy interested in Peter Pan?

Answer: Wendy was deeply interested in Peter Pan because he represented a world of magic, fairies, and endless adventure that was completely different from her ordinary London nursery. She was fascinated by his ability to fly, his friendship with fairies, and felt a motherly and compassionate urge to help him when she found him crying on her nursery floor over his lost shadow.

Q4.2. What role did Tinker Bell play in Peter and Wendy?

Answer: Tinker Bell played a crucial role as Peter Pan's magical companion. She helped Peter search for his lost shadow in the nursery drawers, communicated in her golden-bell language, and most importantly, provided the magical fairy dust that enabled Wendy, John, and Michael to fly through the air to Neverland.

Q4.3. Why did the narrator enjoy having the owls around?

Answer: The narrator enjoyed the owls because they were exceptionally gentle, friendly, and had highly curious, expressive faces. They became cherished members of his household, sitting quietly under the bed, taking food directly from hands, and bathing in the garden birdbath, bringing immense joy and companionship to the family.

Q4.4. What was unusual about the owls in *The Owls in the Family*?

Answer: These spotted owlets were unusual because, unlike larger wild owls, they showed absolutely no fear of humans and were completely non-threatening. They clacked their bills playfully, crooned like hummingbirds when happy, and easily developed a close, affectionate bond with Grandmother, who usually disliked pets.

Q4.5. How did Mary Lennox's life begin to change after she discovered the garden?

Answer: After discovering the secret garden, Mary gained a sense of purpose in reviving its withered plants. Working outdoors in the fresh moorland air made her physically stronger, healthier, and happier, transforming her from a spoiled, lonely, and sour-tempered child into a friendly, enthusiastic, and loving girl.

Q4.6. Why was reading important to the children in *Book Uncle and Me*?

Answer: Reading was important to Yasmin and her friends because books expanded their minds, introduced them to valuable life lessons (like the story of the doves showing that unity is strength), and bound their neighborhood together. The pavement lending library was a cherished local hub of education and joy, making them realize they must stand up to protect it.

SECTION D – LONG ANSWER QUESTIONS (Q6 Topper GUIDELINES)

Q6.1. *The Secret Garden* is a story about change and friendship. Explain with suitable examples from the chapter.

Answer: Frances Hodgson Burnett's *The Secret Garden* is a powerful testament to how friendship and nature can heal and revive withered lives.

At the start of the story, Mary Lennox is a pale, sickly, and selfish orphan. Her transformation begins through her connection with nature (represented by the friendly robin) and her friendship with Dickon. Dickon, with his gentle, animal-loving nature, earns Mary's trust completely, comparing their bond to a 'mistle thrush's nest.' Working side-by-side in the garden, planting seeds, and pruning dry boughs, Mary regains her health and joy.

This healing is then extended to Colin, her bedridden cousin who believes he is a dying cripple. Surrounded by Mary and Dickon's warmth and the vibrant green life of the garden, Colin finds the hope and courage to stand up and walk. The revival of the dead-looking garden directly mirrors the emotional and physical blooming of both children, showing that friendship and care are the ultimate sources of life.

Q6.2. Describe the special bond between the narrator and the owls in *The Owls in the Family*.

Answer: The bond between the narrator's family and the rescued spotted owlets is filled with mutual trust, humor, and respect for wildlife.

Rather than caging the birds as curiosities, the family integrates them as 'regular members of our household.' The owlets respond to this kindness with affection, sleeping under the bed, taking raw meat gently from Grandmother's hands, and even sitting next to the narrator.

This bond of trust extends to the mother owl as well. Though she initially attacks Grandfather in a fierce defense of her babies, she soon realizes they are in safe hands. In an extraordinary display of cross-species trust, she happily leaves her owlets in the nursery, coming back only to leave them food, proving that wild animals respond deeply to genuine human compassion.

Q6.3. What does *Book Uncle and Me* teach us about books, education and responsible citizenship?

Answer: *Book Uncle and Me* teaches us that literacy and public libraries are vital treasures that empower young minds, and that protecting them is the collective responsibility of all citizens, regardless of age. Book Uncle's street-corner library, run on planks of wood with a small donation tin, represents the noble mission of spreading education. His motto, 'Right book for the right person for the right day,' highlights how literature can guide individual lives.

When the library is threatened with closure due to a government permit fee, the children demonstrate the core values of active, responsible citizenship. Inspired by the dove story's moral that 'unity is strength,' they do not remain passive. Instead, they organize a community-wide campaign, create banners, raise awareness, and successfully help choose a mayoral leader who values public libraries. The story teaches that democracy is active, and collective action is the most powerful tool to protect public resources.

SECTION E – REFERENCE TO CONTEXT (Q7 COMPLETE SOLUTIONS)

Situation A: Peter Pan visits the Darling children's room...

a) Who is Peter Pan?

Answer: Peter Pan is a magical, mischievous young boy from the island of Neverland who refuses to grow up, plays with fairies, and can fly.

b) Who are the Darling children?

Answer: The Darling children are Wendy Moira Angela, John, and Michael, three siblings who live in a London nursery.

c) What does this incident tell you about Peter Pan's character?

Answer: This incident highlights Peter's generous, adventurous, and sharing nature. He is eager to share his world of endless magic and freedom with other children, inviting them to fly away with him.

Situation B: Mary enters a neglected garden that has been locked...

a) What is the garden called?

Answer: The garden is called 'The Secret Garden.'

b) Who helps Mary in the garden?

Answer: Mary is helped by Dickon (Martha's twelve-year-old brother) and Ben Weatherstaff, the elderly gardener.

c) How does the garden affect Mary?

Answer: The garden acts as a source of healing and hope. It makes Mary physically strong, active, and healthy, while softening her arrogant, spoiled temper, turning her into a cheerful and loving friend.

Situation C: The children in Book Uncle and Me realise that they can make a difference...**a) What motivates the children to take action?**

Answer: They are motivated by the sudden closure of Book Uncle's Free Lending Library because he cannot afford the expensive municipal permit, and their deep, passionate desire to save their books.

b) What quality do they show?

Answer: They show active leadership, empathy, community responsibility, and determination in the face of civic injustice.

c) What lesson does the story teach young readers?

Answer: It teaches young readers that they are never too young to make a difference in their community, and that unity and collective action are the keys to solving public issues.

Situation D: The poet watches the world rushing past while travelling in a railway carriage...**a) What is the mode of transport mentioned in the poem?**

Answer: The mode of transport is a steam train (railway carriage).

b) Why do the sights seem to pass so quickly?

Answer: The sights pass quickly because the train is travelling at a very high speed, making all fixed, stationary surroundings appear to fly past in a flash.

c) Name one thing that the poet notices during the journey.

Answer: The poet notices several things, including a child clambering and scrambling to gather wild brambles, or painted railway stations whistling past.